relatively richer segments of the population and upper castes. In 2011, a quarter of India's urban population was enumerated as being migrants, and many of them were permanent migrants. These are migrations of entire families as they want to raise their children in the cities.

The big story about work-related migration in India, however, lies between the twin poles of seasonal and permanent migrations. It mirrors what the British did in India, for in the late 18th century historian Gholam Hossein Khan had observed that:[103]

> The English have besides a custom of coming for a number of years, and then going away to pay a visit to their native country, without any one of them showing any inclination to fix himself in this land.

This is the world of semi-permanent migration, where migrants seem to have discovered that 'secret of perpetual motion'. The old adage of most Indians dying in their villages of birth may still be true, but most adult women die outside them as they leave after marriage, and for many men, between life and death, there is a whole new world that is explored. It is this phenomenon that has such a remarkable history that it deserves a separate chapter and a somewhat grandstanding title.